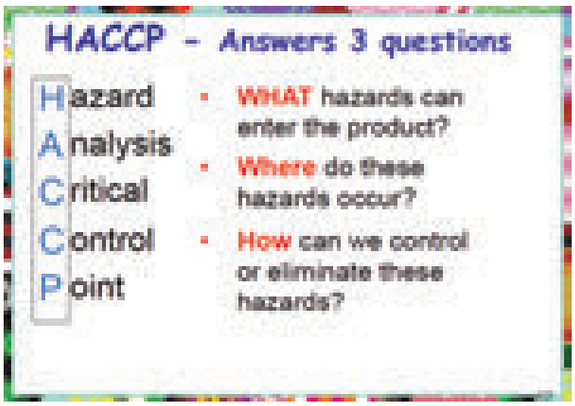



**Figure 5.7 HACCP What? Where? How?**

A **Hazard** is defined as a biological, chemical or physical agent in, or condition of, food with the potential to cause an adverse health effect. Hazards can be

- physical (metal contamination)
- chemical (a cleaning product could contaminate the product or there are toxins that could contaminate the product) and
- biological (bacteria or virus could contaminate the product).

**HACCP** is a procedure that examines each stage in the food production process. It helps to find the hazard that may appear at any stage of the food production process. It critically examines each stage of the food process until it reaches the customer. Once the potential hazard is found in the process, whether it is within the preparation, processing, storage or service, it should be either be eliminated or minimized.

Awareness of food-borne illness is on the rise and concern throughout the industry is driving the use of HACCP and HACCP based certification programmes.




**Figure 5.8 Different types of Hazards**

## Principles of HACCP

- **Conduct Hazard Analysis**

Identification of the hazard is done in two steps, first identify what the hazard is, then evaluate the risk of the hazard for the consumer. The hazard evaluation is a determination of the degree of risk to the consumer.

- **Identify Critical Control Points**

A Critical Control Point (CCP) is a procedure in a food manufacturing process. It can be applied at the point at which a hazard is identified. This will prevent, eliminate, or reduce the hazard to an acceptable level. Thus, food safety can be achieved.

- **Establish critical limits for each Critical Control Point**

A critical limit is the maximum or minimum value to which a physical, biological, or chemical hazard to the food must be controlled. The various methods that can be used to control the hazard should be identified.

- **Establish Critical Control Point monitoring requirements**

The methods for control should be monitored. This is necessary to ensure



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